Centre for CIVIL SOCIETY
SOCIAL CHANGE THROUGH PUBLIC POLICY

Senior Program Specialist, Bolo English Project

Centre for Civil Society seeks a committed, successful, and experienced individual as the Program manager for driving the 'Bolo English' BE Project and two other special projects

Role: Full Time employment role

Work Experience: 8+ years

Location: The position will be based in CCS headquarters at New Delhi

Reporting to: Chief Executive Officer

Starting Date: 1 April 2023

About CCS

Centre for Civil Society is an independent public policy think tank based in New Delhi, working on outreach, research, and advocacy on critical public policy issues that affect India. For the last couple of years, CCS has built a strong portfolio of research and advocacy in education, livelihoods, and governance. CCS offers challenging opportunities in a unique, high-energy, and vibrant work environment. The salary will be commensurate with experience.

1. About the BE project

Launched in July 2020, Project Bolo English is a unique initiative of the Centre for Civil Society. Through this project, we aim to equip children from low-income families with much aspired Spoken English skills. Leveraging the role of Teachers, Schools and Parents as influencers, this project aims to provide children a free, year-long access to renowned Mobile Applications with customized Spoken English content.

One of the core elements of this project is its structured engagement with teachers & parents to provide them high quality language-learning resources, regular updates on students' progress together aimed at improving students' English language skills. We use the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages (CEFR) scale to evaluate the improvement in children's spoken English skills.

Project Bolo English is supported by three renowned philanthropic entities, The Michael and Susan Dell Foundation (MSDF), Procter and Gamble Shiksha Initiative, and The Rising Tide Foundation (Switzerland). Dr. Gurcharan Das (Author and Former MD Procter and Gamble Global), is the mentor of this project.

We have successfully completed the three years of this project with 1,95,000 students, 1000 schools and 10000 teachers from schools in 11 states across India. We are looking to scale the project to 2.5 lakh students and 1000 schools in the year 2023-24.

Teacher Trainers manage the ongoing execution of the Project Bolo English effectively and strengthen the relationships with the stakeholders (school leadership, teachers, and parents).

Program Manager will manage the ongoing execution of the Project Bolo English effectively, and strengthen the relationships with the team of teacher trainers, Outreach consultant and stakeholders (school leadership, teachers, parents and donors). She / He will plan and track processes, follow-up with multiple stakeholders, and facilitate offline and online training sessions to ensure high engagement of students in the program.

Objectives of this Role

- Curate teacher training plan and content for ~20 hours of School based, tech-enabled Spoken English support to students
- Build and develop the team of teacher trainers (6-8) to ensure effective implementation of the project across all geographies
- Lead project implementation which includes activities such as tracking student progress, execution of English language sessions in class, Periodical assessments of students, ongoing monitoring of schools
- Analyse project progress and, when necessary, adapt scope, timelines, and costs to ensure that project team adheres to project requirements
- To coordinate internal and external resources, ensuring projects remain within scope, schedule, and defined targets, in collaboration with the CEO
- Establish and maintain relationships with appropriate stakeholders, providing day-to-day contact on project implementation in schools

Daily and Monthly Responsibilities

- Establish and maintain processes to manage project implementation across its lifecycle, setting project quality and performance standards and assessing and managing the performance of the execution team
- Structure and manage integrated, multi-track project performance trackers
- Develop and maintain partnerships with outside resources—including third-party vendors
- Monitor and assign resources appropriately to streamline project efficiency and to maximize its impact

2. P & G Betiyan Scholarship program: This is an intervention run for promoting girl scholar participation in STEM-related fields of technical studies
3. Mont Pelerin Society General Meeting New Delhi 2024: CCS is the host of the prestigious MPS meeting in September 2024. The incumbent will be a key part of the Working Group tasked to mount this week-long event

Skills and Qualifications

- 5+ years of project management experience
- Hands-on experience with schools, education technology and multi-stakeholders projects
- Proven success working with all levels of management
- Strong written and verbal communication and presentation skills
- Advanced fluency in MS Excel
- Fluency in English and Hindi. Working knowledge of Telugu will be an added advantage, given the footprint in Telangana.

Compensation

CCS recognises that the right candidate will have a significant impact on the success of the project and is prepared to offer an attractive compensation package for the non-profit sector, commensurate with experience.

To Apply

You will need to submit:

a. Your updated CV
b. 150-200 word SOP on why you are best suited for this role

In case of any queries / issues, please reach out to careers@ccs.in

Process of selection

After shortlisting, there will be a written assignment and 2 rounds including 2 in-person interviews (fit, competency and HR) after which the final offer will be made.